Class #4 -- Presentations

Instructions

Navigate to the slide labelled with your number

Design a slide as follows:

- choose an organization and list the strengths and weaknesses you see in it
- then argue that the strengths listed actually constitute threats to the organization's future
- and argue that the weaknesses listed actually constitute opportunities for the organization

Group 1: Emily, Rachel, Gonzalo, Mario

NYU STERN

Strength

- Location (NY and locations in the world), Brand, alumni network
- Turn to Weakness… location (too open to public/safety, protest); Brand (known to be clique, pretentious, exclusiveness); faculty members (high demand - costly)

Weakness

- Cost, Bureaucracy/Established (Top Down?),
- Turn to STR… cost → (good faculty members - that strategy professor; job turnaround!); bureaucracy (i guess it's work! Constraints, check and balance)

STERN

Group 2: Siddh Mandirwala, Jay Daftari, Shipra Dagli, Utsav Doshi

Strengths

- Low-cost furniture
- Flat-pack (easy transport)
- Strong global brand
- Efficient supply chain
- Unique store experience

Weaknesses

- Self-assembly required
- Limited customization
- Perceived low durability
- Large store locations
- Complex store layout

Strengths → Threats

- Low cost → lower quality perception
- Flat-pack → customer frustration
- Strong brand → high expectations risk
- Supply chain → global disruption risk
- Physical stores → shift to online shopping

Weaknesses → Opportunities

- Self-assembly → paid assembly services
- Limited customization → modular/custom designs
- Low durability → premium product line
- Large stores → expand online & small stores
- Complex layout → improve digital tools

Group 3 Nicole T, Adam K, Mark S, Amaan N

Nike

Strengths
- Sponsorships with multiple sports leagues, teams, and countries
- Strong brand presence
- Strong supply chain and scale

Weaknesses
- Falling behind upstart brands with new designs/trendiness (On, Hoka)
- Product concentration in footwear
- Supply chain complexity
- “Jordan” not strong enough

Threats
- Need to preserve brand image, can’t pursue “edgy” campaigns as easily
- Retailers hoard new releases and sell it at a higher price
- Poor labor practices

Opportunity
- Diversify into adjacent complimentary attire
- Ability to concentrate creative collabs
- Football WC 26

Group 4: Sabrina Seneviratne, Laura Villano, Javier Navarro-Machuca, Sreya Basuroy

Strengths: first movers, innovating how people record/take pictures, technology, strong brand partnership, fashionable

Weaknesses: Market alignment, Expensive, Bulky design, Privacy concerns, alternative forms of recording exists, luxury purchase

Strength to weakness: First movers (riske of disruption), Brand partnership can affect life-style reputation

Weaknesses as Opportunities: Untapped market (new users), Privacy for policy maker and trust.

Group 5: Annabel Miller Green, Luke Lamble, Tatiana, Sri Akula, Parker Dawson, Yan Li, Arnab Majumdar, Harshini Vijaya Kumar

sweetgreen

Strengths:

- Locally sourced ingredients and high ingredient count
- Higher quality ingredients

Weaknesses:

- High price point
- Slow service during lunch
- Primarily a lunch option

Risks:

- Option overload for customers
- Higher costs for locally sourced ingredients

Opportunities:

- Discounted salads from 8-10pm (reduce waste & increase foot traffic during slower hours)
- Farmers market on the side for customer to shop for salad kits for group servings

Group 6 - Campbell, Kat, Ricky, Yutong

MARRIOTT

Strength: Broad number of locations and high brand recognition
Threat: Forced to franchise locations leading to varying levels of quality

Weakness: Reputation of hotel only for business travel (60% of bookings are for business)
Opportunity: Reposition as destination for business and leisure: “we all can work remote now, why not work remote from a beach front hotel”

Group 7

Jasmitha P N, Bernardo Linss, Darrel Lung, Eugenia Igarza, Rohan Yellamilli

Strengths

- First-mover advantages
- Scale and network effects
- Diverse content
- Monetization infrastructure
- Strong brand recognition ("go-to platform")
- Algorithm recommendations

Weaknesses

- Free expression vs compliance and IP laws
- Increasing competition (TikTok)
- Lack of transparency in content creation algorithm
- Heavy reliance on Ads income
- Massive resource required for video storage
- Copyright risks

Transition to Threats

- First mover meant its more susceptible to others replicating it
- Raises user expectations, any decline in quality or safety becomes more visible and damaging
- Monetization incentives leads to clickbait and overused template, reducing overall quality

Transition to Opportunity

- Provid huge dataset for training video generation AI model
- Become largest streaming platform, harnessing the original content creators
- Develop stronger licensing partnerships

Group 8 - Joshua A, Ashley BK, Shivam A, Michelle W.

Chosen Company: **NETFLIX**

Strengths:

- Global presence,
- Original content and vast library,
- User Ui/Ux experience,
- First Mover on recommendation engines

Arguments

Strength as Weakness:

- Higher fixed costs related to global expansion.
- Expectation and feasibility of content quality maintenance.
- Privacy concerns on recommendation engine.

NETFLIX

Weaknesses:

- Pricing Structure,
- Increasing competition,
- Stronger User constraints,
- varying degrees of content quality.

Weakness as Strength:

- Premium product placement.
- Increase in quality of pitched products and/or features for differentiation.
- Increased subscriber revenue.
- Diverse content pool that can be used to reach different audiences.

Group 9 - Gracia Max-Harry, Xueyao Zhao, Kavya Pratapa

Google

Strengths

- Increased R&D in generative AI (Gemini and Nano banana) driving innovation
- Improved search results powered by AI

Threats

- Replacement of entry-level positions leading to a dearth of skilled developers
- Overreliance may limit human creativity
- Loss of ad revenue from "no click" AI answers

Weaknesses

- Limited AI integration in ecosystem
- Monetization Uncertainty for AI Offerings

Opportunities

- Integration of AI with Google Workspace (meeting intelligence, tracking action items)
- Build on Google One's inclusion of Gemini Pro by introducing explicit AI subscription tiers for consumers and businesses

Group 10: Emma Johnson, Mack Glavin, Sahil Sarnaik, Ishika Surana, Jamie Varghese, Samantha Lutt, Matt Pulford, Pooja Patel, & Shreya Sukur

Strengths: Control the concert industry, trustworthy, secure platform, fraud protection, dynamic pricing
Weaknesses: Products and services are interconnected, Website crashes all the time, regulatory and anti-trust risk, negative consumer perception

Dynamic pricing poses a **threat** for brand if consumers are price sensitive.

Opportunity for improved design and user experience. Ability to focus on consumer interactions and brand perception.

Group 11 - Ailin Liu, Uka Zhu

Open AI

Strengths:

- Large user base
- General-purpose capability
- Strong market visibility

Threats:

- Harder to introduce narrowly focused new products without alienating the existing customer base
- Every mistake is amplified, increasing reputational risk

Weakness:

- ChatGpt can still generate incorrect or misleading outputs
- Limited transparency in how outputs are generated

Opportunity:

- Encourages hybrid human-AI workflows
- Need for human judgment, opportunity for role redesign

Group 12

Group 13 - Joy Chu, Olivia Burglund, Rhema Obiefuna, Ayesha Kirpalani

Strengths:

- Pricing/Discounts
- Chase Credit Card Partnership/Discount
- Hyper focused on North America
- Owning the largest bike/scooter network

Strengths that could be weaknesses:

- Aggressive pricing kills long-term profitability.
- Over-reliance on Chase creates a single point of failure.
- No international "safety net" if U.S. laws change.
- Bikes/scooters are high-cost liabilities during downturns.

Weaknesses:

- Zero revenue outside North America to hedge risks.
- Lack of diversification beyond rideshare business. No delivery or freight arm to offset ride-share slumps.
- High cash spend required to prevent driver churn.

Weaknesses that can be strengths:

- Lack of global bloat makes them a "plug-and-play" buyout for Big Tech.
- Room to integrate with travel/delivery brands to fill service gaps.
- Driver incentive struggles force innovation in high-margin FinTech/insurance tools.

Group 14- Katharina Denner, Isabella Cai, Rohan Gore, Parnika Gupta, Audrey Green

Germanwings rebranding to Eurowings

- Germanwings was a **low-cost airline** owned by Lufthansa that operated short-haul European flights.
- After the Germanwings Flight crash, the brand became **strongly associated with tragedy and negative public perception.**
- **Lufthansa** planned Re-branding: **Germanwings -> Eurowings.**
- The rebranding helped create **distance from the damaged reputation** and introduced a **more modern, pan-European identity.**
- **Strengths as threat:**
  - Strong brand identity -> after the Germanwings crash, the brand became entirely associated with the tragedy
  - Focused regional identity -> too geographically narrow for expansion across Europe
  - Stong parent brand (Lufthansa) -> limited how far it could differentiate as Lufthansa had to protect its premium brand
- **Weaknesses as opportunities:**
  - Brand damage after crisis -> justification for a full strategic transformation
  - Mid-market positioning (not cheap, not expensive) -> appealing to both budget-conscious and moderate-comfort travelers
  - Limited service -> simplicity reduces operational complexity and costs allowing for faster turnaround times and lower prices

Group 15 | Shi Jie Yu, Gabi Zappitelli, Andrew Steelman, Alex Kontopanos, Katherine Belgrad, Emma Gottsegen, Jim Connolly

SHELL

Strengths

- Existing relationships
- Existing infrastructure
- Global presence
- LIFO Inventory Accounting
- Consistent demand
- Well known brand

Weaknesses

- Organizational inertia / slow moving
- LIFO liquidation = huge tax payment
- Deeply embedded stereotypes/legacy
- Amplified consumer reactions to scarcity

Weaknesses

- Pricing Pressure
- Global Supply Chain Risk & Volatility
- Environmental Restrictions
- Public Perception

Strengths

-
- Global Shipping Network and Naval Fleet
- More cash = protected from volatility
- Forced to be an industry leader